

Scrum

Agile framework for complex product development through short inspection and adaptation cycles.

Scrum in simple terms

Scrum is a lightweight framework for generating value through adaptive solutions to complex problems. Work happens in Sprints with transparency, inspection and adaptation. Product Owner, Scrum Master and Developers have distinct accountabilities, while quality belongs to the whole Scrum Team.

Sprint Planning — run it well

Planning addresses why the Sprint is valuable, what can be done and how the work will be accomplished. Bring refined backlog items, visible dependencies and risks. QA should challenge acceptance criteria, testability, test data, environments, integrations and regression impact before commitment.

Daily Scrum — short and Sprint Goal oriented

The Daily Scrum is a 15-minute event for Developers to inspect progress toward the Sprint Goal and adapt the Sprint Backlog. Do not turn it into manager status reporting. Longer problem-solving conversations should continue afterward with only the necessary people.

Sprint Review — product, feedback and next steps

The Review inspects the Sprint outcome with stakeholders and discusses relevant changes to the environment and Product Backlog. Demonstrate working increments and useful evidence; avoid reducing the Review to slides or a formal acceptance gate.

Sprint Retrospective — improve the way of working

The Retrospective aims to increase quality and effectiveness. Use evidence to discuss process, collaboration, tools, Definition of Done, automation, environments and rework. Finish with a small number of clear improvements and follow them up in the next Sprint.

Product Backlog refinement

Refinement is an ongoing activity, not a formal Scrum event. It is a strong opportunity for QA to surface examples, risks, dependencies, acceptance criteria, data, observability and negative scenarios before Planning.

Artifacts and commitments

Product Backlog connects to Product Goal; Sprint Backlog to Sprint Goal; Increment to Definition of Done. These commitments improve transparency and help QA discuss quality using explicit goals and criteria.

Tools for ceremonies and collaboration

Jira or Azure DevOps can support backlog and Sprints; Confluence or Notion decisions; Miro or FigJam retrospectives and workshops; Teams or Slack communication; Planning Poker tools can support estimation when the team uses that practice. Tools should support conversation, not replace collaboration.

Anti-patterns QA should recognize

Warning signs include QA receiving everything on the final day, unclear acceptance criteria, long Dailies, constant uncontrolled Sprint changes, Reviews without stakeholders, Retrospectives without actions and recurring defects being ignored. Treat them as delivery-system risks, not individual blame.

Example Sprint with integrated QA

Before the Sprint, QA helps refinement. In Planning, QA confirms risks and strategy. During development, QA tests small increments, collaborates on automation and observes integrations. In Review, QA contributes evidence and residual risk. In Retro, defect, flakiness and rework data support improvement.

QA tip

A good Scrum event ends with shared understanding and clear next steps. QA adds more value by surfacing risk early than by waiting for a final test phase.

Official resources

Site oficial: <https://scrumguides.org/>